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# Redmi 9 Power

## Battery beast for power users

**T**he Xiaomi Redmi 9 Power, starting at ₹10,999 for the base variant, has a singular focus, with a sprinkle of additional features. And that singular focus is power, hence the nomenclature. But does it do enough to set itself apart? Let's find out.

### Build and design

The phone is 9.6mm thick, so it's definitely not one we'd dub as slim. On the rear panel, you have a rather obnoxious massive Redmi branding, that frankly, we'd rather do without. The plastic back, however, has a nice textured finish which helps keep fingerprints at bay. On the side, you have a side-mounted fingerprint sensor atop the power button, as well as the volume controls. The buttons are easy to reach and tactile, and the fingerprint sensor, while not the snappiest, is reliable. Redmi also upped the ante by adding dual stereo speakers to the smartphone, so you get both a top and downwards firing speaker.

### Performance

The Redmi 9 Power houses the Qualcomm Snapdragon 662 SoC. In our usual benchmarking tests, the Redmi 9 Power performed decently. We ran AnTuTu on the device and got a score of 182796 and it did lag behind both the Realme Narzo 20, but it managed to beat out the Poco M3 narrowly.

When it comes to gaming, the Redmi 9 Prime does a mediocre job. We played a game of Call of Duty and recorded an average FPS of 29 with 66 per cent stability at high graphics and medium frame rate in the Gamebench app. Lower the graphics to Medium and the game was playable but it does feel choppy and laggy.

Benchmark scores aside, the Redmi 9 Power runs day-to-day operations pretty smoothly, for the most part. Coming to the software, the Redmi



9 Power comes with Android 10 with MIUI 12 atop. Now, if you're familiar with MIUI, you will know that it comes with a galore of bloatware in the form of preinstalled apps and ads, and that's the case with this phone too.

### Display

The Redmi 9 Power comes with an FHD+ display. It is a 6.53-inch IPS LCD display that works well for content consumption. The colours are vibrant, however, the viewing angles are mediocre. You also get support for Widevine L1, so you can enjoy HD content on OTT platforms. The display is bright enough to view indoors. It is rated at 400 nits, and we managed to record a peak brightness of 220 nits. The display, however, is slightly problematic to view outdoors, under direct sunlight.

### Battery life

Now, we move on to what we consider is the primary highlight of the Redmi 9 Power. No second guesses there, it's the gargantuan 6,000mAh battery. The massive cell does exactly what it is supposed to do, which is give you enough juice to 'Power' through about

2 days of moderate usage and about a day and a half of heavy usage. If you're a light user, you can stay away from the charger for days.

### Camera

The Redmi 9 Power packs a quad-camera setup that includes a 48MP primary shooter, an 8MP ultra-wide-angle lens, a 2MP macro lens, and a 2MP depth sensor. Daylight photos taken on the primary lens are decent. The shots are generally sharp and vibrant when shot in bright daylight, with a passable amount of detail. The dynamic range, while lacking in some aspects, is acceptable for this price range. The 2MP macro lens, honestly speaking, is just terrible, due to the lack of autofocus. The 8MP ultrawide lens, on the other hand, produces strictly average shots in daylight with mediocre

dynamic range. Finally, we move on to low light photography, where the shots from 48MP

primary lens suffer from a lot of noise and lack detail, especially in the shadows.

### Verdict

There are 2 main areas where the Redmi 9 Power stands out - the stellar

battery life and the inclusion of dual stereo speakers. If you're someone who consumes a lot of media on your phone, the dual stereo speakers, FHD+ display and the ability to stream HD content on YouTube and Netflix make this a sweet offering in this area. In most other areas, the phone is what you'd expect at this price range. MIUI is packed to the brim with ads and bloatware, so keep that in mind when making a decision.

—Dhriti Datta



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### SPECIFICATIONS

CHIPSET: Qualcomm Snapdragon 662 | GPU: Qualcomm Adreno 610 | STORAGE AND RAM: 4GB+64GB (UFS 2.1), 4GB+128GB (UFS 2.2) | REAR CAMERAS: 48MP + 8MP + 2MP + 2MP | SELFIE CAMERA: 8MP | DISPLAY: 6.53-inch IPS LCD | DISPLAY RESOLUTION: 2340x1080 FHD+ | BATTERY: 6,000mAh | FAST CHARGING: 18W | Weight: 198g

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